Varun Mulchandani

vmmulcha@ncsu.edu | varun-mulchandani.github.io

Location: Mountain View, CA, USA; Citizenship: U.S. Citizen

Research Interests: Reasoning, Large Language Models, Out-of-Distribution Generalization, Spurious and Invariant Correlations.

Education

North Carolina State University — Raleigh, NC, USA
PhD in Computer Science, Advisor: Dr. Jung-Eun Kim — *Aug 2024 - Present*

North Carolina State University — Raleigh, NC, USA
Master of Science in Computer Science, Thesis Advisor: Dr. Jung-Eun Kim — *Aug 2022 – Jul 2024*

- Full Tuition Waiver (3/4 semesters), GPA: 4.0/4.0

Vellore Institute of Technology — Vellore, TN, India
B.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering — *July 2018 – May 2022*

- GPA: 9.34/10

Publications

[1] **Varun Mulchandani** and Jung-Eun Kim. Severing Spurious Correlations with Data Pruning. In International Conference on Learning Representations (**ICLR**), 2025 (Spotlight, $< 5.1\%$).

[2] Xingli Fang, Jianwei Li, **Varun Mulchandani** and Jung-Eun Kim. Trustworthy AI: Safety, Bias, and Privacy - A Survey, 2025.

[3] **Varun Mulchandani**. Pruning's Impact on Spurious Correlations: Using the Right Metrics the Wrong Way. Master's Thesis, 2024.

Experience

X, The Moonshot Factory (Google X) — Mountain View, CA, USA
PhD Resident; Mentor - Ashwini Ramamoorthy — *June 2026 – Present*

- Benchmarking frontier large language models on inductive reasoning tasks involving physical laws and for autonomous electric grid control.

North Carolina State University — Raleigh, NC, USA
Graduate Research Assistant; Advisor - Dr. Jung-Eun Kim — *September 2022 – Present*

- Teaching large language models to ignore irrelevant context in reasoning tasks. Training all deep neural networks to learn representations that are robust to shifts in distribution.

Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory — Livermore, CA, USA
Computing Graduate Student Intern — *June 2025 – Aug 2025*
Mentors - Dr. Bhavya Kailkhura and Dr. Brian Bartoldson

- Worked on improving reasoning abilities of large language models trained with reinforcement learning through continual pre-training and model compression.

Sandia National Laboratories — Albuquerque, NM, USA
Graduate Research and Development Intern; Mentor - Dr. Carter Jameson — *May 2023 – August 2023*

- Built language models to identify occurrences of classified information in official government documents.

UBS — Hyderabad, TG, India (Remote)
Summer Analyst Intern — *June 2021 – August 2021*

- Built tools to automate Data Engineering tasks that were being performed manually daily.

Awards

NC State Graduate Merit Award, 2024 ($3,000)

NC State Travel Grant, 2025 ($1,000)

Chancellor Merit Scholarship Award, 2019

Technical Skills

Proficient: Python, PyTorch, NumPy, Bash Scripting
Intermediate: Java, SQL, Scikit-Learn, Flask, spaCy